

Git

You know Git. This isn't a tutorial — it's the reference for the commands you reach for under pressure and the recovery moves that turn "I just destroyed three hours of work" into "nothing happened." The headline truth: **almost nothing in Git is actually gone.** `reflog` is your time machine. Learn it and you stop fearing the tool.

Daily driver

```
git status -sb           # short, with branch info
git add -p               # stage hunks interactively – review what you commit
git commit -m "msg"
git commit --amend       # fix the last commit (message or staged content)
git commit --amend --no-edit # tack staged changes onto last commit, keep message
git pull --rebase        # avoid the noise merge commits on pull
git push
git push -u origin feature/x # set upstream first push
git log --oneline --graph --all --decorate # the only log you need
```

Branching

```
git switch -c feature/x # create + switch (modern; replaces checkout -b)
git switch main         # switch (replaces checkout <branch>)
git branch -d feature/x # delete merged branch
git branch -D feature/x # force-delete unmerged
git branch -vv          # show tracking + last commit per branch
git fetch -p            # fetch + prune dead remote branches
```

Stash

```
git stash push -m "wip auth" # named stash
git stash list
git stash show -p stash@{0}  # diff a stash
git stash pop                # apply + drop
git stash apply stash@{1}    # apply, keep in list
git stash drop stash@{0}
git stash -u                 # include untracked files
```

Rebase & history surgery

```
git rebase main                # replay current branch onto main
git rebase -i HEAD~5           # squash/reword/reorder last 5 commits
git rebase --abort              # bail out of a bad rebase
git rebase --continue           # after resolving conflicts
git cherry-pick <sha>           # grab one commit onto current branch
git revert <sha>                # safe undo: new commit that reverses <sha>
```

The "oh no" recovery section

```
git reflog                     # EVERY HEAD movement – your undo history
git reset --hard HEAD@{2}      # jump back to where HEAD was 2 moves ago

# undo last commit, KEEP the changes staged
git reset --soft HEAD~1
# undo last commit, KEEP changes unstaged (working dir)
git reset --mixed HEAD~1
# nuke last commit AND its changes (careful)
git reset --hard HEAD~1

# recover a "deleted" branch
git reflog | grep feature/x    # find the sha
git switch -c feature/x <sha>

# recover a single file to a previous state
git restore --source=HEAD~3 path/to/file
git checkout <sha> -- path/to/file # older syntax, still works

# accidentally committed to main instead of a branch
git switch -c feature/x        # branch now points at your commits
git switch main
git reset --hard origin/main   # reset main back to clean

# threw away uncommitted work with reset --hard? if it was ever staged:
git fsck --lost-found          # dangling blobs live here
```

Undo a pushed commit (when you must)

```
# safe (public branch): revert creates a new undo commit
git revert <sha> && git push

# rewriting pushed history (only on branches you own, never shared main)
git reset --hard <good-sha>
git push --force-with-lease    # NOT --force – lease checks nobody else pushed
```

Useful config / aliases

```
git config --global pull.rebase true
git config --global init.defaultBranch main
git config --global alias.lg "log --oneline --graph --all --decorate"
git config --global alias.st "status -sb"
git config --global rerere.enabled true # remember conflict resolutions
```

Things that bite you

- **--force** **vs** **--force-with-lease** : always use the lease version. Plain **--force** will happily overwrite a teammate's pushed work without warning.
- **reset --hard** **discards uncommitted changes permanently** — there's no reflog for unstaged working-dir edits. Stash first if unsure.
- **Detached HEAD** isn't broken — you're just not on a branch. Commits made there get garbage-collected unless you **switch -c** to keep them. **reflog** finds them if you wandered off.
- **git pull** **without** **--rebase** spawns merge commits that clutter history. Set **pull.rebase true** globally.
- **Line-ending wars (CRLF/LF)** across Windows/Mac/Linux — set **core.autocrlf** consistently per platform or use a **.gitattributes** with *** text=auto**.